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STAFF REPORT

Date: Oct 14, 2025

To: Board of Education

From: Jon Franco, Sr. Chief of Operations

Subject: Adoption of Cleveland High School Revised Comprehensive Plan

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BACKGROUND

Board Resolution 6153 referred the planning and design for the Cleveland High School Modernization project to voters as a part of the 2020 bond. On May 7, 2024 Board Resolution 6901 adopted the Cleveland High School Modernization Comprehensive Plan. On April 11, 2025 Board Resolution 7051 adopted a Framework for Delivering Modernized High Schools in a Cost-Efficient Manner.

The Cleveland High School Modernization Project Team (Project Team) has worked with internal stakeholders, external stakeholders, a community Design Advisory Group and the internal Cleveland Modernization Steering Committee to develop a Revised Comprehensive Plan in conformance with the framework established by Resolution 7051.

Finally, this Revised Cleveland HS Comprehensive Plan was first shared at the Facilities Improvement and Oversight Committee (FIOC) and that committee reviewed and recommended to forward it to the full Board at their September 16th meeting.

RELATED POLICIES/BEST PRACTICES

The PPS 2017 Comprehensive High School Educational Specifications (2017 Ed Specs), along with information on current Cleveland High School programming, was used as the basis for programming of the modernized Cleveland High School. The Cleveland High School Comprehensive Plan was also informed by space programming needs of the PPS Climate Crisis Response Policy.

In addition to using these documents as the foundation for the Cleveland High School program,

the Project Team conducted a rigorous outreach and engagement effort over several months. The Project Team met with internal and external focus groups and developed a Comprehensive Plan report for Cleveland High School that presents the desired room requirements, the interrelationships of spaces, specific room requirements and square footages, and most importantly, represents the core educational values of PPS.
The Framework for Delivering Modernized High Schools in a Cost-Efficient Manner included guidelines to meet the PPS 2017 Comprehensive High School Educational Specification's (2017 Ed Specs) minimum requirements for number and size of spaces, meet the needs of the PPS Climate Crisis Response Policy for all-electric infrastructure, reduce the overall size of the project, and develop additional cost reduction options. The Cleveland High School Revised Comprehensive Plan is a result of applying the framework to the design and reducing the overall cost of the project while maintaining the core educational values of PPS.

ANALYSIS OF SITUATION

Cleveland High School is a neighborhood comprehensive high school serving approximately 1,500 students. Located in Southeast Portland, it occupies three separate parcels totalling 11.5 acres. The main building consists of the original 1929 school, 1957 gymnasium, 1958 music and shop wing, and a 1968 classroom addition on a single 4 acre parcel. A surface parking lot sits across 26th Ave from the main building. The track and field is located about four blocks to the east on a separate 6.5 acre parcel. The total building area is approximately 250,000 square feet. The main building is bound by SE Powell Blvd. and SE Franklin St. between SE 26th and 28th Avenues. Powell Park, owned by Portland Parks and Recreation, is located across Powell Blvd. between SE 26th and SE 22nd Avenues. Powell Park is utilized by CHS athletic programs including baseball, soccer, and lacrosse.

A Conceptual Master Planning effort was undertaken in late 2019 to provide a basis of cost estimating for future project planning. Based on cost information and other project prioritization, the Board of Education included $20M for planning and design for the Cleveland High School Modernization project on the 2020 Bond, with the understanding that funds for construction would need to be included for voter approval in a later bond measure.

The Comprehensive Planning effort started in October 2023, culminating in the Board approved Comprehensive Plan on May 7, 2024 adopting the plan to build an all new school consolidated on the single 4 acre parcel where the current building sits. The CHS school program will relocate to the Marshall Campus during the construction phase.

Improvements for athletic facilities at Powell Park, owned by Portland Parks & Recreation, were established as a project alternate in the Comprehensive Plan. The voter approved 2025 Bond included a $15,000,000 allowance for the field improvements at Powell Park and this scope of work is now included in the Revised Comprehensive Plan for the Cleveland High School Modernization project.

The Cleveland High School Modernization project is utilizing the PPS Design Standards, Guidelines and Educational Specifications (Ed Specs) to provide facilities that compare equitably to the recently completed comprehensive high school facilities at Roosevelt, Franklin, Grant, McDaniel, and Lincoln.

FISCAL IMPACT

The total budget identified in the 2020 Bond materials for the planning and design for the Cleveland High School Modernization project was $20,000,000. While rough cost estimates were developed as part of the 2019 Conceptual Master Plan effort, it was understood that new cost estimates would be developed in conjunction with the CHS Comprehensive Plan.

The approved building budget of the Comprehensive Plan was $468,644,850. After following the framework of Resolution 7051 for the Cost Reduction Study, the Revised Comprehensive Plan budget is now $457,553,760 resulting in just over $11,000,000 in savings. The total project budget, including the funds for Powell Park fields, is $472,553,760.

It is worth noting that any delay in the proposed project schedule provided in the attached CHS Revised Comprehensive Plan Report will result in significant additional costs in market escalation that are not included in the estimated project budget above.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

The comprehensive planning phase for CHS included a broad community engagement program. A Comprehensive Planning Committee (CPC) met on six separate occasions to review, discuss and recommend next steps for the comprehensive plan of the modernization project. Since Comprehensive Plan approval in May of 2024 the Design Advisory Group has convened for 12 meetings, while quarterly community meetings have been held at CHS for alumni and families.

Additionally, specific engagement efforts are conducted to include voices from other community groups including those historically underserved and/or underrepresented. More detail about this engagement process is included in the CHS Revised Comprehensive Plan. Presentations and feedback exercises were also facilitated with CHS staff, CHS student leadership groups, and broader engagement with CHS students.

TIMELINE FOR IMPLEMENTATION / EVALUATION

If the proposed CHS Revised Comprehensive Plan is approved, the Architecture/Engineering project team will continue forward with design development and construction documents. This will take place in coordination with ongoing community engagement, including the community-based Design Advisory Group as well as open houses, small focus groups, and other engagement activities. Design is expected to complete in spring 2026.

Construction is scheduled to commence in July 2026 per the schedule provided in the attached CHS Revised Comprehensive Plan. Students and staff will be moved off-site to the PPS Marshall High School campus during construction. The modernized Cleveland High School is scheduled to complete construction in 2029 and open for staff and students for the 2029-30 school year. Any delay in this schedule will incur significant additional costs in market escalation.

Please see the attached CHS Revised Comprehensive Plan Report for more detailed project schedule information.

CONNECTION TO BOARD GOALS

The new modernized Cleveland High School will provide each student with an equitable, individualized, high-quality learning experience and the tools to reach their full potential within an environment that is safe, healthy, and joyful. The new Cleveland High School will embody PPS's Mission, Vision and Values, and its Climate Policy, to strengthen the future of its students and its communities.

STAFF RECOMMENDATION

Staff requests approval of the proposed Cleveland High School Revised Comprehensive Plan.

ATTACHMENTS

A. *Cleveland HS Revised Comprehensive Plan Executive Summary*
B. *Cleveland HS Revised Comprehensive Plan Board Presentation*
C. *Cleveland HS Revised Comprehensive Plan Project Description*